



Small light, desert wide, hope flickers

picture by Echo



**In a vast desert where few ventured, a
tiny lantern dwelled.**





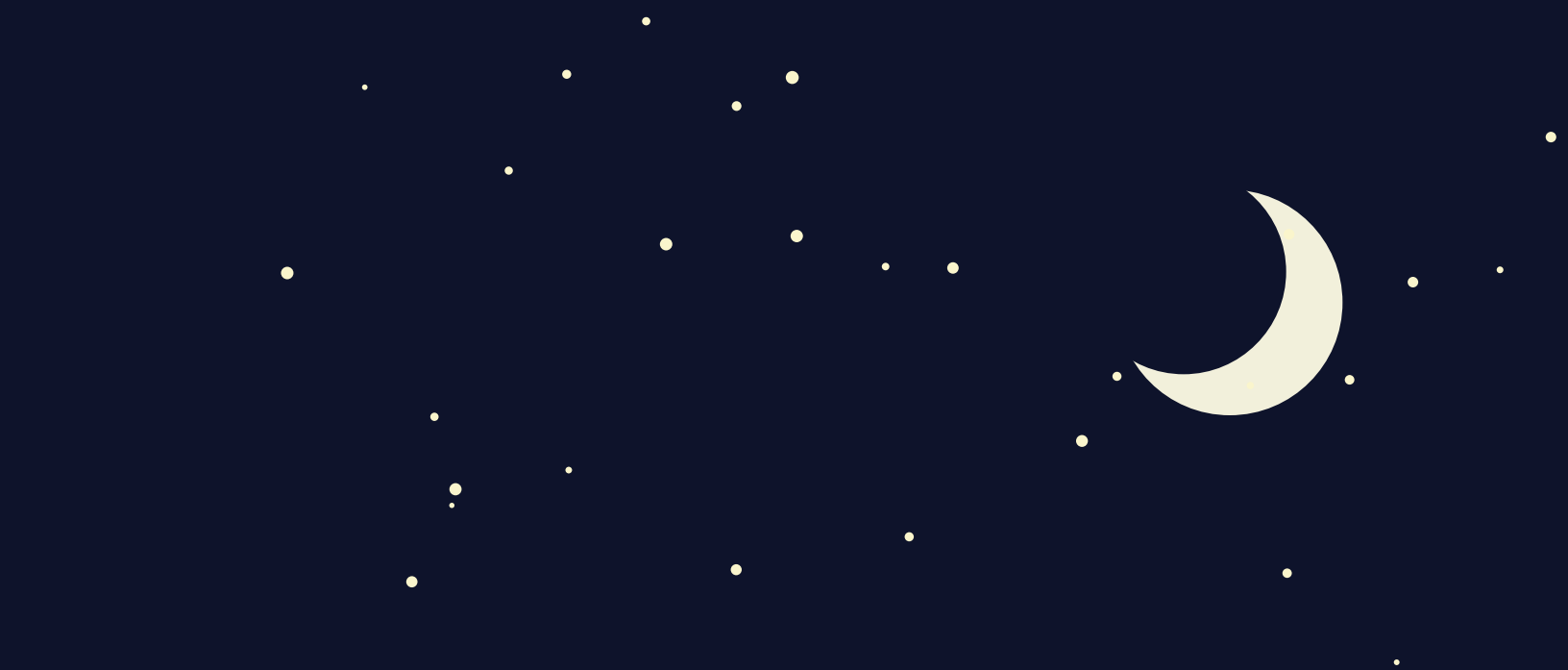
**Very small indeed, the lantern felt
overwhelmed by its immensity--each day,
pondering its worth amidst whispers of
insignificance.**





**One morning, disaster struck--a light
that vanished, leaving all afraid.**



A dark blue night sky with a large, bright yellow crescent moon in the upper right. Numerous small, white stars of varying sizes are scattered across the sky. The bottom of the image features a dark blue background with a horizontal band of a slightly different shade of blue, and two large, dark blue curved shapes at the bottom corners.

"I'm too small," the lantern thought.





Yet it resolved to try anyway.





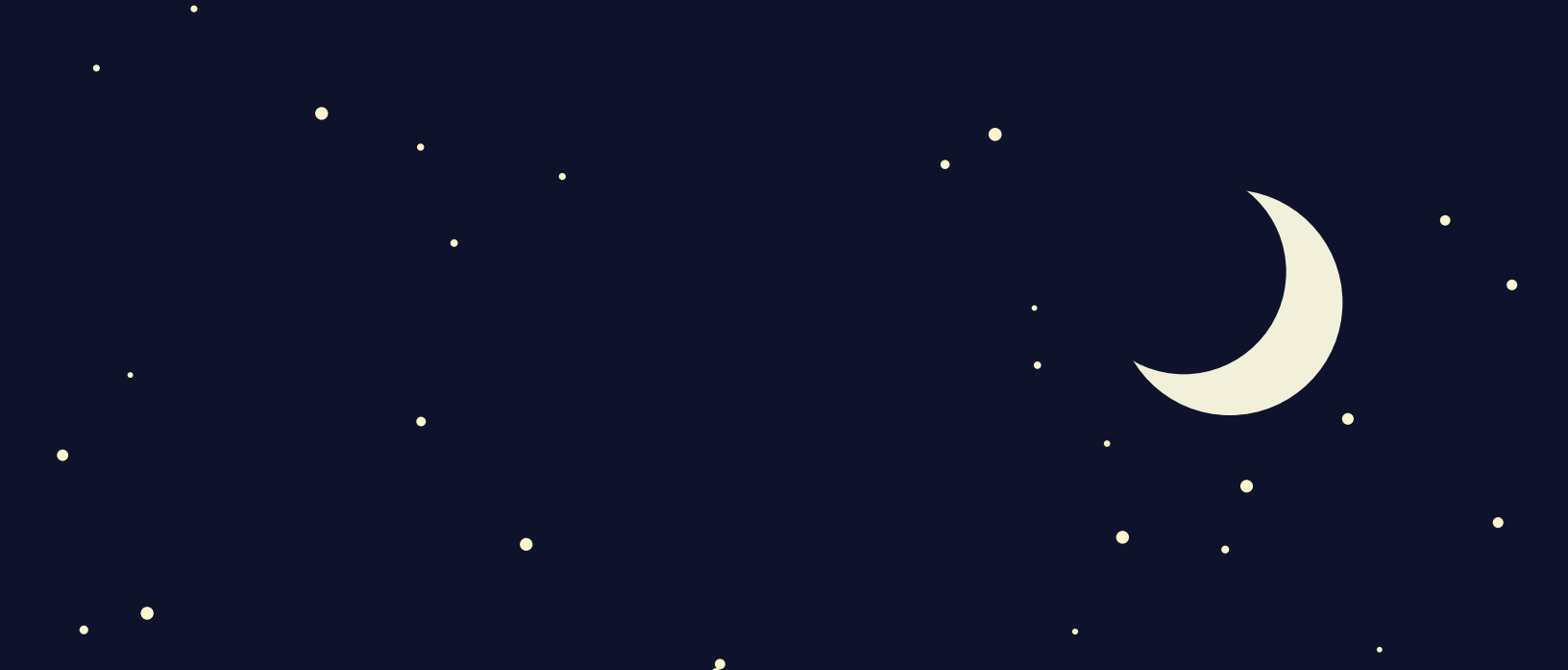
**Breath held, heart racing, the lantern
attempted to restore the light.**





**Remembering faces in need, the lantern
stood tall again.**





Words echoed softly: "You can do it." It believed them.





**Sitting small, feeling tiny, the lantern
faced defeat and persisted--trying once
more.**





The End

asking for help is a kind of courage

